

Chapter 1: The Basic Unit of Life. Cells are the fundamental structural and functional unit of all living organisms. All living organisms are made up of cells. Cells contain cytoplasm surrounded by a membrane, which contains many organelles such as mitochondria, plastids, and ribosomes.

Chapter 2: Cell Organelles and Mitochondria. Mitochondria are known as the powerhouses of the cell. The energy required for various chemical activities needed for life is released by mitochondria in the form of ATP (Adenosine triphosphate) molecules. ATP is known as the energy currency of the cell. The body uses energy stored in ATP for making new chemical compounds and for mechanical work. Mitochondria have two membrane coverings instead of just one.